

WEEK 14

QUESTIONS IN SIMPLE PAST

RADIO: Good morning everyone. Today we have a special guest for our program. Hello Leo, how are you?

LEO: I'm fine, thanks Kevin.

RADIO: I know that you don't have any new movie projects at the moment. You look relaxed. What did you do?

LEO: I went to the Maldives. I had a great vacation.

RADIO: Really? How long did you stay there?

LEO: For 2 months.

RADIO: How was the weather?

LEO: Always sunny, Kevin.

RADIO: Wow! Did you stay at a hotel?

LEO: No, I rented a flat. I stayed there with my family.

RADIO: How about the food? Did you like the local food?

LEO: Very much.

RADIO: Did you miss working Leo?

LEO: No. Not a bit. I didn't miss working.

RADIO: Okay folks. Stay tuned. Just a quick commercial break.

In English, we use the helping verb **DID** to make questions in the Simple Past tense. Helping verbs have no translation in Turkish, but we use them to make both YES / NO and WH- questions.

In English we also use **DID** as verb2 for the verb **DO**. Don't confuse verb2 **did** with the helping verb **did**.

Did you **stay** at a hotel?

How long **did** you **stay** there?

EX: **Did** you **do** your homework last night?

 Here, **DID**

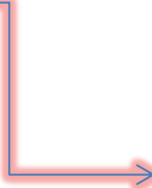
is our helping verb.

We use it to show

that this is

a YES / NO question

in Simple Past Tense

 Here, **DID** is the verb in our question.

Sometimes students confuse the past form of verb to be (was/were) with **DID**. DO NOT forget that **verb to be** is different from the other verbs and can form questions and negatives without a helping verb.

Study the examples below:

EX: My sister **was** ill yesterday.

Was your sister ill yesterday?

*The verb in the above sentence and question is **was**.

EX: My mother **worked** at Marmara University between 1990 and 1998.

Did your mother **work** at Marmara University in the past?

*The verb in the above sentence and question is **worked**.

We use **did** as a helping verb, to ask a question in the Simple Past tense.

If you have a verb in the Simple Past tense other than **verb to be, you must use a helping verb (**did / didn't**) to ask a question or to make a negative sentence.

You can give short answers to YES / NO questions with **DID**.

Study the example below:

A: **Did** you **stay** at home last weekend?

B: Yes, we **did**.

 Here, **DID** is our helping verb, and it helps us give a short answer to a question. And we want to give an affirmative answer, so we say YES, and therefore we use **did**.

A: **Did** he **visit** his parents last month?

B: No, he **didn't**.

 **Here, DID** is our helping verb, and it helps us give a short answer to a question. And we want to give a negative answer, so we say NO, and therefore we use **didn't**.

When we make negative sentences or questions in the Simple Past tense, we no longer use **VERB2**.

We went to the cinema last night.

We didn't go to the cinema last night.

NOT: We didn't ~~went~~ to the cinema last night.

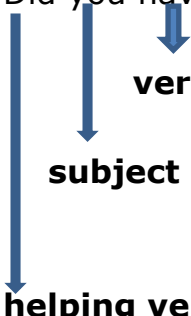
Did you have fun at Raj's party last Saturday?

NOT: Did you ~~had~~ fun at Raj's party last Saturday?

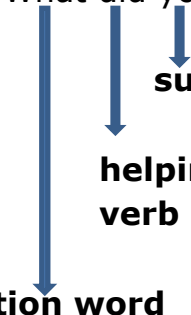
WH- QUESTIONS

Now that you know how to make YES / NO questions in the Simple Past tense, it is easy to understand the WH- questions. The order is the same, but you add the WH- question word at the beginning of the question.

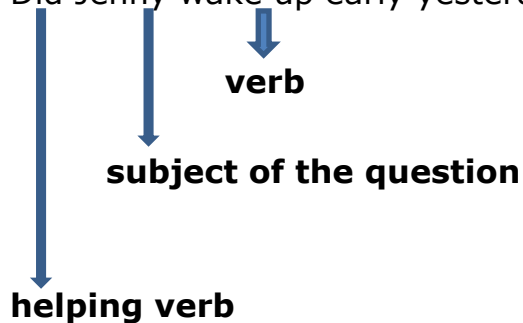
EX: Did you have dinner at home last night?


helping verb
subject of the question
verb

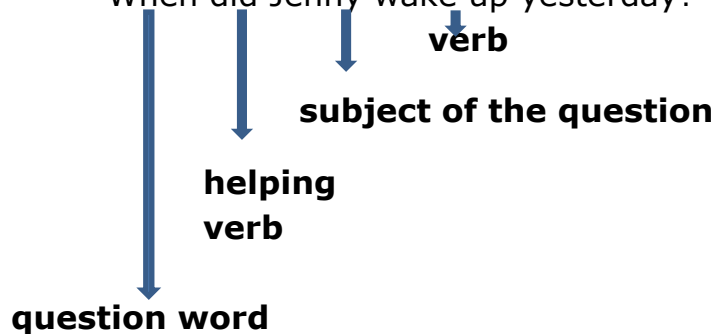
What did you have for dinner last night?


question word
subject of the question
helping verb

EX: Did Jenny wake up early yesterday?



When did Jenny wake up yesterday?



Exercises:

I. Use the words below to write questions and give short answers as in the example.

Example : fly / Neil Armstrong / to Mars ? (X)

A: *Did Neil Armstrong fly to Mars?* B: *No, he didn't.*

1 win / Tony Curtis / an Oscar ? (X)

A: B:

2 invent / Alexander Graham Bell / the telephone ? (✓)

A: B:

3 paint / Michelangelo / the Mona Lisa ? (X)

A: B:

4 exist / computers / in the 1990s ? (✓)

A: B:

II. Write questions for the underlined information.

1. He fell because he slipped on a banana peel.
2. I was born in 1964.
3. It took us about half an hour to get to school.
4. She last rode a bike two weeks ago.
5. I bought half a kilo of cheese.
6. He took his driving test two days ago.
7. He met Linda for coffee.
8. Mike went to the cinema with Jane.

III. Complete the text with the correct form of the verbs given.

In the 1960s there was a race between the Soviet Union and the United States to be the first country into space.

It (1) cost (cost) a lot of money. The United States (2) _____ (spend) about \$100 billion. Both countries (3) _____ (use) German scientists to develop their rockets.

The Space Race (4) _____ (begin) in 1957 when the Soviet Union launched the first satellite, Sputnik. They (5) _____ (send) a dog into space on Sputnik 2. Then, in 1961, Yuri Gagarin (6) _____ (become) the first man in space. He (7) _____ (go) round the Earth once. It (8) _____ (take) 108 minutes.

In 1961 President Kennedy (9) _____ (say) that before the end of 1969 Americans would land a man on the moon.

In 1966 a Russian spacecraft landed on the moon, but there were no astronauts on board.

In 1968 Apollo 8 orbited the moon. Then, in 1969, Apollo 11 (10) _____ (land) on the moon, and Armstrong and Aldrin (11) _____ (walk) on its surface.

The Space Race (12) _____ (end) in 1975 when the Russian Soyuz 19 (13) _____ (meet) and (14) _____ (join) America's Apollo 18 in space.

So the Russians (15) _____ (win) the race to put the first man in space, but the Americans put the first man on the moon.

IV. Read the text and complete the questions.

- 1 'How much did the United States spend?' 'About \$100 billion.'
- 2 'When _____ the Space Race _____?' 'In 1957.'
- 3 'What _____ the Soviet Union _____ into space on Sputnik 2?' 'A dog.'
- 4 'When _____ Yuri Gagarin _____ the first man in space?' 'In 1961.'
- 5 'How many times _____ he _____ round the Earth?' 'Once.'
- 6 'How long _____ it _____?' '108 minutes.'
- 7 'When _____ Apollo 11 _____ on the moon?' 'In 1969.'
- 8 'When _____ the Space Race _____?' 'In 1975.'

Reading

Read the text and answer the questions.

John Lennon

1940-1980

John Lennon was one of The Beatles. With Paul McCartney he wrote some of the greatest songs of the 20th century.

John Lennon had an unhappy childhood. His father left home when he was five. His mother couldn't bring him up, so John lived with his aunt Mimi until he was 39. When he was 17, his mother died in a car crash.

He went to Quarry Bank High School in Liverpool. He met George Harrison and Paul McCartney, and in 1960 they started a band called The Beatles.

The Beatles recorded their first single 'Love Me Do' in 1962. They became famous in 1963, when they played more than 200 concerts. In 1966 they went to the United States for the first time and played on American television.

End of concerts

The Beatles stopped playing live concerts in 1966 because the audience made so much noise that nobody could hear the music. But they continued to record songs, and in 1967 they made the album Sgt Pepper Lonely Hearts Club Band. The last album they recorded together was Abbey Road.

John Lennon married the artist, Yoko Ono, in 1969, and in 1970 The Beatles broke up. John and Yoko moved to New York. John wrote and sang his most famous song *Imagine* in 1971. In 1980 he recorded a new album, Double Fantasy.

He was killed a month later. An American, Mark Chapman, shot him outside his New York apartment near Central Park. Two days before his murder John Lennon told an interviewer 'I feel safe in New York. I can go anywhere, It's my home!'

I. Read the text and complete the sentences.

1. John's father left home when he was five.
2. His mother died when _____ .
3. He started The Beatles with Paul and George in _____ .
4. 'The Beatles' played more than _____ concerts.
5. The last album they made was _____ .
6. 'The Beatles' broke up in _____ .
7. John and Yoko lived in an apartment near _____ .

II. Ask questions for the given answers.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Who <u>did</u> John <u>live</u> with? | He lived with his aunt Mimi. |
| 2. How ____ his mother ____? | She died in a car accident. |
| 3. Where ____ John ____ to school? | Quarry Bank High School in Liverpool. |
| 4. When ____ The Beatles ____? | They started in 1960. |
| 5. When ____ they first ____ to the United States? | In 1964. |
| 6. Why ____ they ____ playing live concerts? | Because the audience made too much noise. |
| 7. Who ____ John ____ in 1969? | Yoko Ono. |
| 8. Where ____ they ____ to? | New York. |
| 9. When ____ John ____ and ____ Imagine? | In 1971. |
| 10. Where ____ Mark Chapman ____ John Lennon? | Outside his apartment. |